

Wirtshaus Labor

Location

Salzkammergut, Oberösterreich, AT
(multiple locations)

Building Type

former inns, gastronomy venues

Reuse

temporary gastronomic use
(pop-up, experimental space)

Usable Area

~ 40-100 m²

Governance Model

publicly initiated + educational
institutions + gastronomy sector

Project Duration

2023-2024



Initial Situation

- Increasing decline of traditional inns in rural areas
- Vacant or underused gastronomy venues
- Structural challenges in the gastronomy sector (*labour shortages, economic pressure*)
- Need for new concepts for contemporary inn culture

Reuse Strategy

Strategy: temporary use of vacant inns as a “laboratory”, with pop-up gastronomy & changing mobile formats (e.g. *installations at different locations*)

Combination of:

- Culinary experiences
- Culture & events
- Experimental concepts

Character: experimental, temporary, site-specific

Objectives

- Revitalisation of vacant inns
- Development of new gastronomic concepts
- Promotion of young gastronomers
- Strengthening of regional food culture & community

Operational Concept

- Implemented by students (*tourism schools*) + experienced gastronomers
- Project within the framework of the European Capital of Culture Salzkammergut 2024
- Strong involvement of regional producers

Key Actors

- **Initiative:** European Capital of Culture Salzkammergut 2024
- **Implementation:** tourism schools + gastronomers
- **Partners:** regional businesses, producers, cultural actors

Key Features of the Project

- Activation of vacant inns through temporary use
- Combination of education, practice & experimentation
- Use as a testing ground for future gastronomy concepts
- Flexible use across multiple locations

Transferability

What makes this example particularly instructive?

- Shows how vacant gastronomy spaces can be activated
- Demonstrates use as an experimental & learning environment
- Connects education with real-world operation

Who is this model suitable for?

- Municipalities with vacant inns
- Regions experiencing a decline in gastronomy
- Projects in the fields of education, culture & regional development